

Sales Training Debrief — Session 12

Sell the System. Don't Explain It.

Sales training led by Corie Dawson, Director · Thursday 21 May 2026 · Marketing Sweet

1. The CD Notes commission system is back

The novelty-note trade-tray system that produced the agency's best month last July is being relaunched. Same mechanics, one important change to how the offer gets framed.

How it works:

- Two notes — a \$25 “booking” note and a \$50/\$100 “close” note (CD Dollars). Date-stamped, team and rep name on the back.
- Three trays — Tray 1 holds this week's bookings and deals to close. Tray 2 holds next week's. Tray 3 holds outcomes: deals won, deals lost, meetings attended.
- Every Friday afternoon the trays get reshuffled. Whatever's not closed moves through or moves out.

Commission anatomy:

- Lead-gen rep: \$25 when the booked meeting is attended for 15 minutes or longer (regardless of outcome).
- Lead-gen rep: \$50 if the deal closes under \$500 in margin. \$100 if over \$500.
- Closer: separate commission, tiered by deal value.

2. The mistake — explaining the system instead of selling it

When the sales manager presented the new commission scheme to the floor, the \$25 booking note went in the tray first and the bigger close commission was treated as a footnote. That's the error. Reading off the rules is not selling — it's explaining.

“You're not pitching the \$25. You're pitching the four-times bigger close commission sitting next to it. The \$25 is just lubrication to keep lead-gen moving — it's not the main event.”

The fix is to put BOTH notes in the tray together — the booking note AND the bigger close commission — so the rep sees the total prize sitting there waiting to be earned. Frame it as a 4x multiplier, not as a guarantee of \$25.

THE RULE Pitch the trophy, not the participation prize. The \$25 is the safety rope. The close is the climb.

3. The ABC mindset framework

Most people live in two mindsets without realising. Three options exist, but 90%+ of the population sits in B or C:

- A — ABUNDANCE. Faith that opportunities are everywhere and money is flowing. You have to push uphill to stay here — abundance is against gravity.

- B — LACK. “I’m underpaid. There’s not enough. It’s tough out there.” This is what most people default to when things go wrong.
- C — DRIFT. Blissful nothingness. Not actively negative, just floating through. Comfortable. The trap most senior people fall into after early success.

The pattern that takes people out of A:

1. Start with nothing → forced into abundance mindset by necessity. Push against the current. Things start working.
2. Get to a comfortable level → drift into C. “I’m on a good wicket now.” Slow down.
3. Standing still actually equals going backward, because inflation and competition erode the position quietly.

■ *“Be grateful but unsatisfied. Always understand abundance is available.”*

4. Sell, Sell, Sell — the only rule when in doubt

The first job of a sales manager is selling. Not selling to customers — selling to everyone. Selling is the default operating mode.

- Sell to customers. The obvious one.
- Sell to your staff. Every day. Every interaction. About the opportunity, the money, the future.
- Sell to people at the supermarket. At the bar. Recruiting in the wild.
- Sell to your peers. About the company, the brand, the wins.

The maths of asking versus not asking:

4. Ask 10 people if they want to work with us → roughly 2 will say yes. 8 say no. Net result: 2 conversations started.
5. Ask 0 people → guaranteed 0 yeses. The ego saves itself from rejection by giving up the opportunity.

THE THREE-WORD RULE When in doubt: sell, sell, sell. Three times. To three different people. Today.

5. The Wallace test — silent belief is not belief

There are two ways to believe in something. Quietly, to yourself. Or visibly, to everyone around you. The leadership question: which one looks like belief from the outside?

Imagine two people who believe in God. One holds it privately. The other talks about it constantly — invites people to church, evangelises, won’t shut up. If God had to pick which one represents the brand, which one wins?

■ *“The silent believer doesn’t move the line. Wallace didn’t keep it to himself — he sold the dream of freedom to everyone he met. That’s belief in motion.”*

Applied to the company:

- If you genuinely believe in the commission scheme, the team should hear about it 10 times a day, not once a fortnight.

- If you genuinely believe in the company, talk about it at the supermarket, at family dinners, at the gym.
- Quiet achievers carry more credibility than loud-mouths — but only if they speak up. Quiet doesn't mean silent.

6. Treat your staff like customers

The next leadership skill is realising the team downstairs is the most important sales pitch you'll do all week. Apply the same closing skill you use on a customer to the people you're paid to grow.

The four questions to ask every team member, weekly:

6. How much do you want to earn this week? (Specific number, not a feeling.)
7. What are you saving for / driving / dreaming of? (Anchor to a real prize.)
8. Based on the commission scheme, how many deals does that require? (Walk them backward.)
9. Who can you bring in today to help you hit that? (Activity = the only variable they control.)

If a manager doesn't know what each direct report wants by Friday afternoon, they haven't done the job that week.

7. Earning is learning — the 300% rule

Pay rises don't come from working harder at the same job. They come from doing a different job — adapting, juggling more balls, adding skills. The maths of the gap:

PAY INCREASE WANTED	EFFORT-CHANGE REQUIRED
+10%	Change attitude/positioning by ~30%.
+50%	Change what you do by ~300% — new skills, new responsibilities.
+100%	Change what you do by ~10x — different role, different person.

Not 300% more hours — 300% more capability. Adding a second ball to juggle, then a third, then a fourth. The 10-year benchmark:

“If you put yourself from 10 years ago into your current job, what's the likelihood they could do it? Roughly 0–2%. That's because the work isn't the same work — the skills compounded.”

8. The complacency trap

Getting to “row one” — the first level you wanted — is the dangerous moment. The new car arrives, the move-out happens, the first big pay rise lands. The brain says “mission accomplished” and pulls back.

What's actually happening:

- Inflation strips real income value every year. Standing still means going backward.
- New tax rules quietly erode what you built. Same outcome.
- Competitors don't pause. The team next door is still moving.
- Everything you have, you're borrowing — including the position. Stop protecting it and it goes faster.

Anchor for the second climb:

10. Find something specific you can't currently afford — a car, a house deposit, a holiday, a business.
11. Use that to manufacture pressure on yourself. Discomfort generates drive.
12. If you're not slightly uncomfortable, the drive is gone — and the income follows.

9. Action items this week

13. Put BOTH notes in the tray — the \$25 booking note and the \$50/\$100 close note — for every booked lead.
14. Re-pitch the commission scheme to every lead-gen rep this week. Lead with the close commission, not the booking commission.
15. Sit down with each direct report. Ask the four questions. Write down their answers.
16. Match each rep's target income for the week to the number of deals it requires. Walk them backward through the maths.
17. Recruit in the wild. Ask 10 people this week — supermarket, gym, family events. Track yeses and nos.
18. Build the buffer. Identify a second and third lead-gen rep to bring in before the current one becomes a single point of failure.
19. Pick one thing you can't currently afford. Pin it on your desk.

THE ONE-LINER The \$25 is the safety rope. The \$100 is the prize. Sell the prize.